Program instruction manual

Madison Building Inspection Document Writer

Release 2026-10-18 R51 · Helper 2026.10.18.52 · 18 October 2026

This manual explains how inspectors prepare documents, preserve case history, recover unfinished work and use Reports. It also gives administrators the installation and maintenance procedures needed to support the program. Follow the division's actual authority, court instructions and records policy when using these features.

R51 is a packaged release candidate for City acceptance. Its security checks require the same ordinary document, history and recovery procedures described below. Automated verification does not replace the outstanding City Windows and network tests, staff and assistive technology acceptance, or legal and seasonal policy decisions listed in the carried-forward City acceptance record. New mandatory-appearance citations remain blocked until approved defendant instructions are supplied and integrated. Historical frozen reprints remain available. No live deployment is included in this release.

Using this manual

Inspectors can begin with chapters 1 and 3, then follow the procedure for their current task. Administrators should read chapters 2, 15 and 19 with the deployment guide. Chapters 21 and 22 provide troubleshooting and training exercises. The contents links jump directly to each chapter.

The HTML edition opens from Tools & settings. Keep the printable edition with the accepted release. Current operating guidance supersedes historical release notes; it does not replace division legal authority or the required acceptance record.

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1 Start here and daily routine

Document Writer prepares Official Notices, Extensions, Citations, Referrals for Prosecution, Compliance Letters, Summary Abatement Orders, Non-Summary Abatement Orders, No Occupancy documents, Best Interest Extensions and Vacancy Extensions. It retains linked corrections, physical inspection history, private drafts, original PDF receipts and reporting summaries. Referral updates and occupancy releases are modes within their families.

Before using operational cases. Have IT install the complete deployment, link the approved shared folders and confirm the independent integrity anchor. Have the division complete the acceptance record and authorize the workflows staff will use. The program's entry of a reviewer name is a retained statement, not authentication of a role or proof of legal approval.

Start a working day. Run the Document Writer desktop shortcut or installed launcher. Keep one Writer tab open in the same browser profile. Confirm Build 2026-10-18 R51 and helper 2026.10.18.52. Open Workspace and resolve any save confirmation, shared-history or PDF-filing exceptions before creating replacement work. Check pending deadlines and reminders.

Prepare work. Use Import inspection for a new case or unused completed inspection. Use Workspace to continue a retained document or worksheet. Add the appropriate language, fill all case-specific details and assign required deadlines deliberately. Use Show checks or Inspection checks to find incomplete fields. Saving an unfinished draft is permitted even when issuance checks are unresolved.

Finish an action. Review the complete document, citation copies where applicable, dates and recipients. Use Review & issue only when the facts and required approvals are complete. Wait for confirmation of the shared save. Then verify original PDF filing, printing, actual mailing or email sending, and the division's court or Accela recording separately.

End a working day. Use Save & continue later and verify device saving. Resolve or preserve queued work through Saved work & connection. Download a workspace backup when moving profiles or when recovery is needed. Close Writer and the helper when instructed for an update. Do not clear browser site data while unfinished work exists.

The five Writer destinations are Import inspection, Workspace, Order language, Reports, and Tools & settings. Reports opens separately. Editing a case remains within Workspace; returning from Reports offers Back to Reports.

2 Install update and verify the workstation

Administrator procedure. Use the deploy folder from the R51 deployment package. Do not install individual files from source. Inspectors do not need Node.js or npm. The supported environment is 64-bit Windows with Chrome or Edge and a compatible Python version listed in the generated deployment guide. Classic Outlook is the supported draft handoff target; New Outlook has not been accepted.

1. Back up the existing program, case folder, PDF folder, GIS folder, configuration and integrity evidence. Ask every user to save and sync work, close Writer tabs and close the old helper window.
2. Before extraction, compare the package SHA-256 with the digest obtained independently from the release owner. Use Get-FileHash -Algorithm SHA256 in PowerShell. Keep verified prior packages separately for deliberate IT rollback and test acceptance in isolation.
3. Place all deploy files and the vendor folder in a division-owned program folder. Preserve operational folders and settings. Grant inspectors read-only program access and grant write access to the release owner only; grant case, PDF and GIS write access as required. Keep these permissions distinct. Restrict administration and independent anchor permissions through IT.
4. Have IT check the deploy ZIP’s SHA-256 against the value the release owner publishes separately, then run Start Document Writer.bat once on each PC from that checked deployment. It installs the local runtime and creates the desktop shortcut.
5. Confirm the R51 build and helper versions. If an older helper is running, close that helper and its browser tabs, then run the launcher again.
6. Open Tools & settings → Saved work & connection. Expand Connection checks and technical details, then open connection checks and Storage diagnostics. Confirm the intended shared paths, helper health and permissions. Use Rebuild reporting index in Storage diagnostics when an administrator has confirmed a rebuild is appropriate.
7. Open Reports → Data and definitions. Review coverage and excluded records. Test an approved synthetic case through save, exact PDF retrieval and recovery before operational use.

Compatibility. R51 retains the preceding verified releases' case schema 5, summary version 6, workspace backup version 2 and authoring version 11. Earlier releases predating schema 5 cannot read schema-5 case files. A runtime rollback changes installed files; it does not reverse issued records or restore workspace data. IT must assess data compatibility and retained requests before rollback. Never replace current operational records with an old backup without an approved recovery plan.

Checked updates. After the first installation, launch from the installed desktop shortcut. Before replacing program files, the launcher checks the shared deployment against runtime-manifest.json: exactly the listed files, each with its listed size and SHA-256, and no older release than the one installed. Missing, extra, changed, partial or older copies are refused and the PC keeps its current version. This catches mistakes and damaged copies; protection against deliberate tampering comes from the deployment folder being writable only by the release owner.

Browser session. The installed shortcut connects this browser to the current helper session. A fresh unauthenticated browser page asks you to open that shortcut. The shortcut supplies the temporary connection secret and the page immediately removes it from the address bar. Never copy a shortcut session URL into a message or another user's profile. Requests to case, PDF, email and administrative services require the current session. The public readiness probe exposes only version and readiness.

After a helper restart. A previous session cannot submit another request. Reload the page in the same browser profile to reconnect. Private work remains in the original profile. If the page asks you to use the installed desktop shortcut, use it. Review any retained save confirmation or pending request before retrying; a refusal does not prove whether an earlier request completed. Do not clear site data or create a replacement issued action.

Deliberate rollback. IT first preserves the complete current installation, device profile and backup, operational records, PDF receipts, configuration and independent anchor evidence, then closes the helper and tabs. Restore the separately retained trusted earlier installer using the documented rollback procedure. The shared folder never downgrades a PC automatically. Runtime rollback never rewinds issued records or replaces current case data.

The generated Start Document Writer - READ ME.md is the file-level installation reference. R51-ACCEPTANCE-RECORD.md at the package top level provides the required City test and signoff form.

3 Use Workspace and case history

Workspace is the queue for cases loaded on this device. It starts in Needs attention. Continue work, Deadlines, Needs resolution and All cases provide other views of the same loaded cases. Counts represent cases rather than individual tasks within a view; a case may appear in more than one view. Summary buttons clear the search and inspector filters. Check the View selector when the expected case is not visible.

Find and continue a case. Search this workspace by address, case number, owner or parcel. Apply the inspector filter if useful. Use the main action beside the case to continue its next task. It may say Continue import, Continue document, Continue reinspection, Complete recorded visit, Reinspect or View case. An uncertain shared save takes priority over starting another draft. A record verification problem takes priority over editing.

Open Case details and history for secondary actions, the document list, timeline, case export and Put away. Put away removes a case from this device's queue after the relevant safeguards; it does not delete the shared case. Use Search all cases in Tools & settings to locate records outside the current device workspace. Open saved case can load an exported case record, subject to the program's shared-history checks.

Understand the record. A case retains the original numbered items and the issued event history. A new visit records what happened on a genuinely completed inspection. A correction amends a recording error in an existing action. A record note adds an explanation without rewriting the earlier document. A withdrawn item keeps its identity and reason and is not credited as corrected.

Issued documents use frozen source facts. Changes to current owner details, catalog wording or policy do not rewrite an old issued PDF. Review current case facts for future documents and use the correction process when issued evidence contains an error.

Resolve attention states. Open the named case action rather than making a replacement case. Confirm save uses the retained original request. Review shared changes compares the current shared record. File issued PDF completes original filing after issuance. Saved work & connection explains whether the remaining work concerns this device, shared cases or PDFs.

Navigation first saves device work. If that save fails, Writer keeps the current screen and offers a workspace backup. Keep the tab open and preserve that backup before restarting or clearing anything.

4 Import a case or later inspection

Direct lookup. Open Import inspection, enter the complete case number and choose Find case or press Enter. The Windows helper runs the supplied read-only SQL query with the signed-in Windows account. Inspectors do not enter SQL, passwords or server settings. The initial default server is sqlelam; IT can set the approved database and server in shared Case Lookup/settings.json.

A new case with one unambiguous eligible completed initial inspection may advance directly to its draft. This does not issue a document. When there are multiple eligible inspection results, no inspection is selected automatically. Select the actual unused completed inspection. Scheduled, Pending and Assist inspections are excluded. Pending, missing-date and unsupported rows explain why they cannot be used. Accela result statuses Completed, Official Notice, Citation and Compliance are eligible when the inspection has an actual date and a supported type. Official Notice, Citation and Compliance are inspection results, not proof that this program already issued a document. The program checks its shared record separately to prevent reusing an inspection. Unknown statuses stay blocked and show the source result for correction.

Review an existing case. Check the case number, address, selected inspection and proposed property or owner changes. Expand source details if needed. Choose Continue existing case to open its retained draft, worksheet or latest effective issued source without importing the proposed changes. Choose Import later inspection only for an eligible unused physical inspection after the shared preflight succeeds. Existing unfinished work and reused observations must be resolved first.

Excel alternative. Open the SSRS Excel alternative and select the division's exported inspection report. Review the same identity and completed-inspection facts and confirm explicitly. CSV paste and manual case creation are not provided. Use the actual Inspection Time column; a missing time stays blank and a scheduled date does not substitute for an actual inspection date.

Record Category Snow Removal selects the snow workflow and preloads its 10.28 item. The new-case workflow selector is an additional deliberate choice, not a way to bypass missing or reused inspection facts. Existing case and file identities remain stable.

Pause or retry. Save & continue later retains the lookup or review on this device. A retained review is a snapshot with its retrieval time; use Find case again for fresh information. Cancel lookup suppresses its result. A failed or empty lookup preserves prior work. If the shared case changed, review the refreshed comparison and confirm again. A delayed earlier result must not replace the current case or reopen Import after navigation.

The source query has no permanent inspection ID. Matching uses case, type, actual date and normalized time, with conservative handling of missing historical time. Do not alter time to bypass a reuse warning. See CASE-LOOKUP-GUIDE.md for SQL setup and diagnostic codes.

5 Prepare an Official Notice

Start from the imported initial inspection. Verify owner, property, parcel, inspector, inspection date and any supplied time. Expand the case details when a check identifies a missing field. Review the mailing block rather than relying on an address parser to establish ownership or service.

1. Open Add items. Find the appropriate selectable order language and select it once. A checkmark means it is already on this notice. Select it again to remove it from the unissued draft. The same library entry cannot be added twice.
2. Choose Done adding. Review each item's ordinance, corrective action, location and case-specific details. Outlined fill-in bubbles identify missing details. Click a bubble or focus it and press Enter, enter the factual detail, and review the sentence afterward.
3. In Assign due dates below the document, select the items sharing a deadline, enter the date and choose Apply to selected. Use Select all when appropriate. Repeat for other groups. New items begin without an automatic deadline.
4. Keep no more than three distinct outstanding-item deadlines under the existing notice rules. A batch that would create a fourth is rejected without changing the items. An invalid individual edit may be saved as work in progress but blocks issuance.
5. Review the whole document, not only the edited sentence. Check recipients, contact details, the mailing date, the item order and all warnings. Use Show checks to jump to the affected field and correct it.
6. Choose Save & continue later to retain unfinished work, or Review & issue when ready. Verify the resulting save state.

Private wording edits belong to the retained draft. Removing and reselecting the same source in that draft restores its identity, edited text, ordinances, due date, location and notes. A newer catalog version requires explicit review and adoption; it does not silently replace private wording.

Initial citations. Select Cite only for the items actually being charged. Complete Initial-inspection citations before using Issue notice and citations together. The deadline record and citation save atomically; the initial-citation letter carries the notice content. The notice is retained as Delivered within the citation rather than producing an extra owner notice. Each charge has four court copies. No reinspection is invented.

Use a correction after issuance. Do not renumber or delete historical items to hide an error. The program's checks support the division's process; a green check is not a legal determination about the selected ordinance or deadline.

6 Find select and review order language

Order language and the Add items picker use Approved language by default. Search ordinary words, a title, an ordinance or a catalog identifier across checklists. Multiple terms narrow the results. Trash, garbage, rubbish and refuse are related search terms; handrail, railing and banister are also related.

Each result shows an ordinance and a short corrective-action preview. Open Full wording and guidance for complete text, fill-ins, retained draft wording and review provenance. Check the status before selecting. “Review status from cache · refreshing” identifies retained browser review information while the helper checks it. “Review status from cache · refresh unavailable” means that check could not finish. A cached label does not grant approval or bypass the helper's publication checks; reconnect and refresh when current review confirmation is needed.

Scope or status	Meaning for use
Approved language	Formally recorded approved entries; the default discovery scope
Approved and standard	Deliberate broader scope; standard entries retain selection eligibility but have no recorded formal approval
Needs review	Proposed or incomplete entries for review; not a shortcut to selection
Standard and retired	Reference scope including replaced or retired sources
Selected on this notice	Sources already selected, even if their later status changes

Unreviewed proposed, incomplete, replaced, retired and unavailable sources cannot be newly selected. Find approved replacement locates an alternative; it does not change the draft. Review and use v… opens a comparison before adopting a new source version. Issued documents remain frozen.

Review administration. An authorized reviewer opens Review administration within Order language, or Order language review in Tools. Select the entry, compare bundled/current/unsubmitted wording, and supply the actual reviewer, corrective action, ordinance references and source or authority. Identify a replaced entry where applicable. Confirm the intended review explicitly.

Recording creates an immutable shared version. If another operator has submitted a newer version, compare it and choose Use current v… as review basis before retrying. The app preserves unsubmitted forms on this device, including later edits made while a save was pending.

Review save was not confirmed may indicate a lost acknowledgement after a successful shared write. Refresh and compare recorded status before retrying. A later browser-cache failure does not undo an acknowledged shared review. During an outage, cached status is last-known information and cannot authorize proposed wording. New issuance still requires the normal successful shared review check.

Named reviewers are operator-supplied. IT permissions and division authority govern who may record decisions. Favorites and role-based logins are not configured by this release.

7 Prepare and complete citations

Open the charge card for each selected item. Its summary shows the charged ordinance, citation number, dates and amount status. Edit charge and dates exposes the editable facts; Pricing details and authorization shows the schedule resolution, assessments, counted history and approved basis. The court faces are previews of the same retained charge.

1. Select one actual charged ordinance for each item. An item with several listed sections needs an explicit single choice. Multiple offenses under one ordinance require the appropriate offense selection.
2. Verify the description, citation number, officer or department identifier, issue date, violation date and time, court date and session. Court suggestions are not reservations; use the division's current court and numbering instructions.
3. Complete any required measurements in that charge card. Conditional or unmapped entries require review; the program must not borrow an unrelated amount.
4. Complete the deposit method and its source. Choose Complete charge after the required fields are valid. Other unfinished charge cards remain unfinished.
5. Review all four court copies for every charge and the complete letter before issuance. Confirm shared pricing/history checks. Changed history or a changed charge may require another deliberate pricing review.

Deposit method	What the inspector supplies
Schedule	The applicable unambiguous verified entry, offense and required measurements; review the computed tier and history
Approved base + assessments	The actual approved base, required court-cost facts and an approved source or reason; the program calculates the total
Approved total (assessments included)	The actual approved final total and authority; the program does not add assessments again

A recorded source documents the operator's basis; it does not create court approval. A determined amount remains read-only unless the separate authorized administrative exception process is used. Blank differs from an explicitly approved zero base. Total cash deposits must be valid positive currency where required. Consult the current schedule and division policy rather than using an old example amount from a guide.

Equivalent ordinance formatting retains the approved basis. A different ordinance or offense requires the appropriate new review. Unchanged-charge corrections retain historical pricing and court costs. Citation issue date and a corrected document's mailing date are separate facts.

Mandatory appearance. New mandatory-appearance issuance is held in both Writer and the helper until approved distinct defendant instructions are integrated. Keep the draft and contact the division policy owner. Do not enter a deposit or switch the charge merely to bypass the hold. Historical frozen reprints are not rewritten.

8 Prepare snow removal citations

Snow is a dedicated MGO 10.28 workflow. Record Category Snow Removal selects it automatically; an eligible unissued new case can also select the snow workflow deliberately. It uses the one snow item without an Official Notice, ordinary deadline or fabricated reinspection event. Other violations require a separate case.

1. Import the actual completed snow inspection. Verify parcel/site, respondent, mailing address, inspector, date and time.
2. Enter the accumulation date, a positive decimal depth in inches and the observed condition: snow covered, ice covered, or snow and ice covered. Confirm photographs and select the corner-lot/curb-ramp option when factually applicable.
3. Check the timing message. The supplied rule allows until noon City time on the day after accumulation. An observation before that point is blocked. Use actual facts; never adjust the date or time to pass a check.
4. Review ordinance 10.28, number, description, comment, counted property history, deposit and court session. Refresh citation history if prompted. Missing parcels use the existing normalized address fallback, which requires particular attention to source identity.
5. Review seasonal letter content. After an authorized administrator changes it, choose Refresh seasonal letter and review the new content. Stale shared content prevents issuance until reconciled.
6. Review & issue, confirm the shared save and verify the original PDF. The standard authoring-11 packet includes the snow cover and retained language-access continuation plus four MC-2000 copies; a cover may continue onto another page. Do not force a five-page total or remove language to shorten the packet.

The snow item has no due date. Ordinary deadline assignment, reminders, overdue calculations and Days to compliance do not invent a deadline for it. The default closes the snow case when its PDF is filed; that status does not confirm mailing, payment, court disposition or Accela recording. A later unused snow inspection can still create its next citation within the same case. The same property/date/time observation cannot be cited again.

Division policy decisions. The packaged defaults use a July 1 season boundary, count prior different owners at the same property and close on PDF filing. These defaults, the description, labels, contacts and seasonal content need actual division confirmation. The bundled sand-site list is the supplied 2025–26 material with no named current seasonal review. A warning does not certify the list for 2026–27.

Tools & settings → Review snow-letter content records the administrator, reason, source and confirmation. New snapshots freeze the content actually used. Old reprints do not automatically adopt a later season or price.

9 Record a reinspection

Open Reinspect from the case or import an eligible unused completed reinspection. Enter the actual physical inspection date and time and the responsible inspector. Review all items is the entry view. Carried compliance and withdrawn items remain visible and cannot be casually reset. Progress covers active items; withdrawn items are listed separately.

Walk through items. Choose Start walk-through. The current item shows its original number, wording and original deadline. Choose 1 Corrected, 2 Progress, 3 No change or 4 No access. Quick mode advances to the next unresolved item. Complete details, then next holds the item for dates and notes. Skip for now leaves details unfinished; Return to unfinished details finds them again. Review all items pauses the walk-through and exposes the complete worksheet.

Date field	What it records
Actual inspection date and time	When the physical visit occurred
Result date	When that item's observed finding occurred; within the initial-inspection-to-visit interval
Next due date	A future repair deadline where the selected extension or citation requires one

Previously confirmed compliance retains its historical result date. No access is not compliance; record the factual access attempt in notes. Changing the visit date moves only implicit result dates; explicitly entered dates remain and are checked. References to original deadlines remain distinguishable from new deadlines.

Use Undo last result or U to reverse the last worksheet result within its context. Shortcuts are ignored in editable fields and for held keys. Moving to another case clears the current focus and Undo context. There is no bulk automatic completion of item outcomes.

Open Inspection checks for missing or inconsistent facts. A check reveals all rows and focuses the exact affected field. Completing outcomes also exposes all items for final review. Select the required action group and an available document only after reviewing the facts. Nothing is automatically chosen as the legal action.

Save & continue later retains incomplete or invalid work only after device saving succeeds. A draft's Review inspection action returns to the worksheet and retains its previous draft. Restore previous draft and inspection recovers that exact paired state, including private wording. A pending issuance must be confirmed through its retained attempt before changing the worksheet.

One physical visit may support a primary follow-up and compatible scoped documents. Issuing another compatible document does not create another inspection. See the next two chapters for eligibility and authority requirements.

10 Choose follow ups and document families

In the reinspection chooser, select Give more time, Take enforcement action, Restrict occupancy or Confirm compliance. Then choose a document and Create draft. Choices are labeled primary follow-ups or additional scoped documents. Open All document types (10 families) / why unavailable for the complete list and reasons. The program explains eligibility; it does not recommend a legal action.

Family	Usual purpose and entry
Official Notice	Initial numbered correction requirements from the imported initial inspection
Extension	Additional time for selected outstanding items after a recorded visit
Citation	Selected actual charges from an initial inspection or eligible follow-up
Referral for Prosecution	Refer outstanding violations; includes Update for Case Referral after referral
Compliance Letter	Confirm verified correction of all active items through the applicable completed visit
Summary Abatement	Reviewed immediate nuisance action with its own authority and facts
Non-Summary Abatement	Reviewed nuisance order with compliance, service and court facts
No Occupancy	A continuing scoped occupancy restriction, or its expressly reviewed release
Best Interest Extension	A reviewed supervisory extension with its own plan and exclusions
Vacancy Extension	A reviewed vacancy model with appointment, repair and expiration facts

An extension changes selected deadlines, not the historical original deadlines. A citation charges selected outstanding items; all carried items remain accounted for. A referral does not invent a new repair deadline. After City Attorney referral, ordinary new extensions and citations are unavailable through this path. A referral update or applicable compliance action preserves the referral history.

On an issued action, Add another document for this inspection offers compatible choices for that verified visit. An unfinished action resumes first. A conflicting primary action or already issued family is unavailable. Retry a retained uncertain request instead of creating another action.

Create a scoped order / administrative letter from current case facts requires an explicit selection. It uses the factual existing inspection and adds no new visit. New observations need an actual new inspection. An initial emergency order can start from the imported initial inspection through Initial inspection action without inventing an earlier notice. An initial Official Notice can later use those same retained inspection facts.

Compliance closes the applicable violation case only after confirmed shared publication. Withdrawal is not compliance. Continuing occupancy restrictions remain separate even when violations are corrected or the building becomes vacant. A physical No Occupancy placard is not generated by this release.

11 Complete scoped orders and authority review

The five scoped order and administrative families begin without legal approval. Drafting is possible while review is incomplete. Before issuance, supply the actual division reviewer, current-code source, revision or effective date, amendment review, current-code review date, approved authority/wording/procedure reference, signer and delegation. Assigned inspector, authorized signer and issuing operator are separate retained facts.

Summary Abatement. Identify the nuisance condition and location, required work, immediate-action basis, applicable approved preset or custom condition and signer. Tree orders need the required assessment reference. Removal/disposal wording applies only when removal is selected. Building securing must state actual openings, materials and animal conditions; boarding requires its prior written approval reference. No universal sidewalk clearance is assumed.

Non-Summary Abatement. Record findings and required work, the approved order compliance date, service/publication plan, reviewed Circuit Court remedy and signer. Service dates, compliance dates and court facts are distinct. Issuing a document does not prove completed service or trigger actual abatement. After actual service, record Service and court evidence with method, date and evidence reference. Later or corrected evidence retains earlier events.

No Occupancy. Specify the actual building or unit scope, findings, truthful posting status, effective date, release conditions and signer. A restriction does not end automatically through compliance, vacancy, ownership change or an unrelated expiry date. Written release is a mode within this family: select the exact active restriction and document verified corrections, the real release inspection, actual placard removal and the approved release form. Reference an existing recorded physical visit, or record a genuinely completed external release inspection with its inspector, date and external reference. The program does not fabricate violation results for it.

Best Interest Extension. Identify the prior notice, selected eligible items, owner's plan and benefit, supervisor review, and factual exclusion of safety or urgent items. Internal supervisory prosecution review is not a City Attorney referral.

Vacancy Extension. Verify vacancy, request, selected items, maintenance/security conditions, review appointment, approved deadline/expiration model and transfer/disclosure wording. Contact-by is calculated seven calendar days before the actual review appointment; short notice needs the approved procedure reference. Conditional; no replacement repair dates retains historical repair dates. Renewal requires a new reviewed action. Apartment scope preserves common-area duties.

A referred case needs an explicit reviewed exception and City Attorney coordination for an otherwise eligible emergency or occupancy action. Draft wording, supplied templates and synthetic test approvals are not proof of current law. Use the division's actual review; current-code and procedure approval remain documented acceptance items.

12 Review issue file and deliver

Review the complete letter and every associated court copy. Check the case identity, respondent, item scope, factual dates, mailing date, recipients, signature authority, approved pricing and all unresolved checks. Clicking a check reveals the relevant collapsed section and focuses its specific field. Fill-in bubbles, missing dates or sources, shared conflicts and policy holds must be resolved before issuance.

Issue deliberately. Open Review & issue, read the summary and confirm the intended action. Writer first retains the exact issue request on this device. The helper validates and publishes the document and any new visit together to the shared record. Initial notice/citation companions use their atomic batch. Only confirmed shared publication establishes issued status.

State after an attempt	Correct next step
Save confirmation needed	Confirm the retained original attempt; do not make a duplicate document
Shared publication rejected	Read the current conflict, pricing, catalog or integrity check; review and resolve before retry
Issued with PDF filing needed	Open the issued action and File issued PDF or review its original filing status
Waiting for connection	Keep the retained request/draft and follow Saved work & connection

Original PDFs. The filing process retains the exact prepared original and its receipt. Retry retrieves and files those same bytes when available. A marker that says previously filed is not enough if the actual original cannot be verified. Do not regenerate a different document as a substitute for missing original evidence. A draft PDF is visibly a draft and is not proof of issuance.

Print and mail. Verify every page in the actual viewer. Use the City-approved scaling and envelope/print settings established during acceptance. Inspect all four MC-2000 copies, long letters and snow continuation pages. The authoring-11 initial packet may have six pages. Do not remove a continuation merely to meet an old page-count expectation.

Email. Select and verify the recipients in the issuance review. Outlook handoff opens a draft; inspect its subject, addresses, body and attachments and send under the division's procedure. Opening Outlook or successfully preparing the draft does not prove sending, receipt or service.

Outside records. Complete actual mailing, court filing, approved abatement steps and Accela recording separately. Document Writer is not an Accela write integration or an automatic dispatch service. Use retained record notes for relevant factual references; do not describe a filing attempt as completed delivery.

13 Correct documents and preserve history

Choose the action that reflects what actually happened. Edit an unissued draft directly. Use Correct document for a recording error in an issued action. Use a new physical inspection for later observations. Use a record note when an earlier action has dependent work or when an explanation should be retained without altering the frozen source.

1. Open the issued document from case history and choose Correct document.
2. State the recording error and reason. For a citation or referral, record the actual receiving court or City Attorney amendment instructions/reference where required. The program does not issue those instructions for you.
3. Make the permitted correction. Review the before/after comparison, affected case facts and linked worksheet facts. Keep the original document, item, root, visit and citation identities.
4. Review and issue the linked revision. Until its shared save is confirmed, the earlier issued version remains effective in the program.
5. Confirm the correction's original PDF and complete outside amendment, mailing and recording steps under the actual procedure.

Withdraw an item. Within correction, select withdrawal for an item entered in error and record a specific reason. Its original number remains. It is excluded from compliance credit. Do not delete it or label it corrected to remove it from the count.

Correct a visit. Correct the recorded visit or follow-up type amends that same visit under the existing transition rules. It does not add another visit. If later dependent work makes an earlier direct correction unavailable, retain a record note and correct the current action as permitted.

Citation prices and dates. An unchanged charge retains its original amount, basis and historical court costs. A changed charge needs its own current authorized pricing review. Citation numbers do not change as a substitute for the court's amendment process. The corrected mailing date is separate from the original action's issue date. Reports count the effective citation once while preserving the original and correction history.

Restrictions and release. A wording correction cannot change No Occupancy scope into a permission to occupy, or silently alter substantive release/expiration conditions. Those changes need a newly reviewed action. Withdrawal of a scoped order needs its reason and division instructions/reference. An ordinary compliance letter is not an occupancy release.

Starting or abandoning a correction does not withdraw the original. Current case-detail corrections may inform future documents and reports; the earlier frozen body and PDF remain evidence of what was issued.

14 Understand saved work and connection

Open Saved work & connection from Tools & settings, below Workspace, or from the case's recovery link. Its three sections describe separate facts. Read the section that matches the problem before retrying.

Section	What a successful state means
This device	The browser has retained unfinished work in this profile; it is not an issued shared document
Shared cases	A request was confirmed against the shared case; Shared copy current describes that last confirmation
PDF filing	The exact original PDF's filing or pending work; actual mailing and outside recording remain separate

Device save failure. Keep the tab open. Download a workspace backup directly from the error or recovery area. Retry device saving after addressing the browser storage or profile problem. Do not navigate away, clear site data or assume an unsaved field reached the helper.

Uncertain shared save. Use Confirm save for the retained attempt. A missing response does not prove no write occurred. The helper's retry protocol checks the original request identity. Creating a new citation or event risks duplication and is the wrong recovery step.

Shared changes. Use Check shared record when you need a fresh comparison. Another PC may have changed the case since the last confirmed save. Review the differences; do not overwrite a newer shared history with an older local copy. Conflicting, unreadable or outside-edited records require the named resolution path.

PDF exceptions. Open the issued document and verify or complete its original filing. Review PDF outbox lists retained local PDFs waiting for transfer. Select only the intended files. Printing from the outbox uses retained bytes; successful transfer does not establish mailing. If a same-name target has different bytes, preserve both evidence sources and ask the administrator to resolve the conflict.

Repeated unresolved messages appear once. Dismissing an alert does not clear its underlying case state. Message history in Tools retains dismissed messages. Case-specific integrity evidence is read-only for inspectors.

Expand Backups and recovery for one-case recovery, a new unfinished-work recovery copy, a workspace download or empty-workspace restore. Expand Connection checks and technical details for helper/share/SQL information, Storage diagnostics, Inspect a case lock and catalog checks. These are diagnostic actions, not permission to force an uncertain save or remove a remote lock.

15 Back up restore and recover safely

Workspace backup, a case-record export, an unfinished-case recovery copy and a program rollback solve different problems. Select the one that matches the loss. Keep backups in the division's approved location and follow its retention policy.

Operation	What it preserves or restores
Download workspace backup	Device drafts, worksheets, unfinished forms, retained case facts, save checkpoints and pending requests together
Download case record	Case metadata and issued history; not the complete private workspace
Back up unfinished work now	A fresh helper recovery copy of unfinished work
Recover an unfinished case	One case after a shared-change comparison and deliberate replacement safeguards
Restore workspace backup	A complete workspace into an empty workspace
Program update rollback	Installed program files; not an automatic reversal of issued records or device data

Recover one case. Open Saved work & connection → Backups and recovery → Recover an unfinished case. Select the intended recovery copy and check the case and capture time. Compare the current shared record. Preserve any differing local work before explicitly replacing it. Resume the recovered draft and confirm device saving; resolve retained pending requests through their original confirmation actions.

Restore a workspace. Preserve the current profile first. Use an empty workspace and the same approved program release or a verified compatible version. Choose Restore workspace backup, select the intended file and review its identity. Do not use restore to merge two independently edited active workspaces. Recheck shared state and PDF filing after recovery before issuing.

Change PCs or browser profiles. A private draft does not automatically follow the Windows account. Export it through the workspace/recovery procedure and confirm it opens in the intended profile. A different local URL or profile may have different browser storage. Keep the source profile until the restored work is verified.

After an update interruption. IT checks the installer's retained release state and logs before retry or rollback. Keep operational data, integrity registry, anchors, PDF receipts and device backup intact. Restoring a stale whole-share backup can discard later confirmed work from other clients and must be coordinated as an incident recovery.

Test recovery. Use isolated synthetic cases for restore drills. Verify private wording, partial citation values, worksheet outcomes, pending original identities and exact original PDF retrieval. A successful program launch alone does not prove that the data and recovery paths work.

16 Run reports and interpret their dates

Open Reports from Writer. The common choices are visible in its rail; More reports lists the remaining reports. Every report describes its population and date basis. Filters act on retained verified summaries; drafts do not become issued report actions.

Report	Principal date and counting basis
Open cases by area	Open on the selected as-of date after an issued notice or snow citation
Cases by inspector	Cases opened in the period, by case inspector and area
Open violations by area	Items still open on the as-of date after notice issuance
All cases	Cases opened by initial inspection date in the period, with current status
All violations	Non-withdrawn items on cases opened in the period
Days to compliance	Initial inspection to item correction; excludes snow cases
Repeat cases by owner	Two or more opened cases, grouped by usable owner mailing address
Citations by ordinance	Effective non-void citations issued in the period
Overridden deposits	Authorized exceptional determined deposits issued in the period
Referrals for prosecution	Referrals issued in the period, with owner facts as referred
Document actions	Effective issued actions in the period; includes scoped actions before a notice

Use From/To for period reports and As of for historical open-state reports. Date shortcuts set the corresponding range. Open More filters for additional scope such as status, owner, violation type or ordinance. Applied-filter chips reveal active scope even when its control is collapsed. Reset filters returns to the current year, current district boundaries and unfiltered optional fields, and clears sorting.

Click a sortable column heading to set its order. The active screen, CSV, matching workbook report sheet and print use the same stable row order. Other named workbook sheets retain their own definitions; do not assume every sheet uses a citation issue date merely because the active report does.

Saved local views retain their report, dates, filters, map choice and sort. Relative local date choices recalculate on use. Shared views retain their established filter/date/map format without shared sort. Manual report switching clears the saved-view selection and old return notice while retaining the working filters and sort context.

Owner grouping by mailing address can combine owners represented by the same manager; names are shown for interpretation. Citation tiers count effective issued history, not an external conviction feed. Document action counts can exceed visit counts because compatible actions can share one physical visit.

17 Verify report coverage maps and exports

Check coverage first. Open Data and definitions. Review the read time, included case files and excluded summaries. Missing summaries, exact source-revision mismatches, earlier-format summaries and unreadable or duplicate entries are explained separately. Categories can overlap; an unreadable-entry count is not a unique-case count. Do not add them together as a case total.

Each included current summary must match the independently read case bytes and integrity proof. A rebuild regenerates summaries; it does not repair altered case history or grant legal approval. An administrator should first resolve the underlying record issue, then use Tools & settings → Saved work & connection → Connection checks and technical details → Storage diagnostics → Rebuild reporting index. Refresh Reports and recheck the exclusions before relying on totals.

Maps. Switch between table and map when the report supports a map. Select area/boundary and basemap choices deliberately. GIS enrichment depends on access to City services; records without a usable location remain disclosed. Use the map's table alternative for the same report population and review unlocated records. A missing point is not evidence that a case was excluded from the report count.

Drill into data. Open a count or case link to inspect its underlying cases. Open a case in Writer to continue its existing work. Back to Reports restores the retained report context and sort. Check dates and filters after a return or data refresh, especially when a source record has changed.

Export. Expand the export controls. CSV downloads the active report rows. Workbook downloads the collection of named sheets, including the matching report sheet with numeric/date values where appropriate. Print uses the active report presentation. Check the title, date range, applied filters, row order and coverage statement before distributing an export. An invalid date range clears stale report results so an earlier table is not exported as the new request.

Deposit schedule. The deposit explorer presents searchable human-readable rules, conditions, effective dates and source details. Pagination limits screen volume; it does not omit the retained schedule. A displayed row may be conditional or require an authorized manual amount. The explorer is not a new court policy. If a sort fails, the report displays its default order and a notice; review the active order again before distributing an export. A malformed helper response reports its HTTP status and asks you to refresh or contact IT rather than showing an unreadable response as current report data.

Refresh speed. The helper overlaps a maximum of four read-only file operations per request while retaining independent revision and integrity checks. Allow a shared read to finish before treating its coverage as current. Actual City cold/warm performance, history volume, simultaneous users and budget approval still require measurement.

18 Use planning tools and display controls

Tools & settings groups actions by purpose. Cases & planning contains Search all cases, Reminders and Batch draft due dates. Saved work & connection and Open saved case handle persistence. Administration contains Order language review, Administrator deposit override and Review snow-letter content. Display and help contains theme, message history and shortcut help. Program instructions opens this manual and its printable PDF.

Search all cases. Use the shared search when a case is not loaded in Workspace. Review identity and open it through the existing shared-history checks. A search result does not override a conflict, active draft or unreadable record.

Reminders. Configure the intended reminder period and enabled state. Workspace exposes applicable reminder actions. Draft a reminder, inspect the recipient and wording, and complete the Outlook sending step separately. Reminders do not change a due date, prove service or create a new inspection. Snow items have no ordinary deadline reminder.

Batch draft due dates. Select eligible unissued notice drafts and the required deadline, then apply it deliberately. Review each resulting draft. This updates private draft deadlines; it does not amend an issued notice. Ordinary outstanding-item date limits and snow exclusions remain enforced. Use the correction workflow for issued deadlines.

Open saved case. Select a case-record export when appropriate. It is different from a workspace backup and does not contain every private form or worksheet. Opening it still respects current shared state and identity safeguards.

Display. Choose Light, Dark, High contrast or System. System follows the browser or operating system setting. Reduced-motion preferences remove nonessential transitions. Theme changes affect the screen; issued document print bodies retain their established appearance.

Messages. Read persistent error and recovery messages before dismissing them. Message history retains dismissed notices for review. A dismissed notification does not mean a pending save or PDF job has completed. Keyboard help is available here and through ? outside an editable field.

Administrative deposit exceptions. Only an operator acting under actual division authority should use Administrator deposit override. Supply the actual named administrator, reason, source and required confirmation. The helper records authorization and Reports exposes overridden deposits. This does not change the master schedule, establish court authority or approve unrelated citations.

Keep technical diagnostics with the administrator. Avoid putting passwords, operational personal data or whole case folders in casual support messages. Provide the specific safe error code, time and approved log excerpt needed to investigate.

19 Administer configuration integrity and maintenance

Use the division's IT and policy owners for changes. Deploy configuration as a coordinated release or through the program's explicit shared administration workflows. Do not edit live JSON histories or generated HTML to work around a check.

Shared folders. Program files are read-only for inspectors. Case JSON Files, Documents To Be Mailed And Recorded and Reporting GIS need the intended helper read/write access. Restrict Case JSON Files_administration to authorized administrators while allowing the reads required by inspectors. Keep integrity settings and the independent anchor under IT control.

Protected anchor. The anchor is outside the case folder and reachable by every inspector PC. IT supplies integrity-settings.json locally on each PC and protects the configuration through its approved administration procedure; the launcher never copies that file from the share, including when no local file exists. IT configures append/create-only anchor access without modify/delete and verifies the actual NTFS/share behavior. The case-folder registry alone provides only partial tamper protection. Keep anchor backups and permissions with the records recovery plan.

Record holds. A damaged migration registry or outside-edited case is an incident, not a reason to run an index rebuild repeatedly. Preserve the file, registry, retained PDFs and independent evidence. Inspectors use read-only review. Administrators use the documented offline integrity tooling only after establishing the trusted source and approved recovery plan.

Locks. Inspect a case lock shows diagnostic information. Age alone never establishes abandonment, particularly on a remote PC. Do not delete lock files manually. Coordinate the owning client, confirm its state and use the token-bound recovery procedure only when the required evidence permits it.

Approved connections. The release contains trusted-connections.json. GIS URLs must use HTTPS on an approved host; the defaults are maps.cityofmadison.com and opendata.arcgis.com. Credentials, HTTP/file URLs, unapproved ports and responses above 20 MB are refused, and redirects must stay on the approved host. The SQL server in Case Lookup/settings.json must exactly match an allowlist entry (shipped: sqlelam). Allowlist changes are made by the release owner in a new release, not through share settings.

SQL. The shipped query uses typed case-number parameters and read-only Windows integrated authentication. Shared Case Lookup/settings.json accepts server, database and enabled. Choose a trusted certificate chain and matching server name. The SQL server must also appear in the release allowlist (trusted-connections.json), whose initial approved entry is sqlelam. A per-user certificate-validation workaround cannot authorize an off-list server. The existing per-profile certificate-validation bypass is an exceptional IT decision documented in CASE-LOOKUP-GUIDE.md; do not copy it into shared settings or make it the normal deployment default.

Policy and catalog. Record actual authority for language approval, new scoped documents, pricing exceptions and seasonal content. Mandatory defendant instructions need a separately approved source and release integration. Existing supplied pricing-date and snow-default questions remain policy decisions, not automatically approved by R51.

Retention. Retain case events, migration evidence, anchor receipts and exact original PDF operation receipts according to approved records policy. R51 does not compact or delete them. Future compaction requires records approval and proof of archived-byte retrieval and interruption recovery before implementation.

Release ownership. Only the release owner writes to the deployment folder's program files; inspectors have read-only access there. The release owner builds each release with the complete gate (tools/verify_release.py, then tools/package_release.py), publishes the deploy ZIP's SHA-256 through a separate trusted channel, and keeps the previous complete release for deliberate rollback. IT records the folder permissions in the acceptance record.

20 Use keyboard touch and accessible views

Use Tab and Shift+Tab to move through controls. Enter or Space activates the focused button or disclosure where appropriate. Visible focus identifies the active control. Click a validation link to open its section and move to the specific field; after correcting it, verify that the error state clears.

Shortcut	Scope and result
?	Outside an editable field, opens keyboard help
Ctrl+S or Cmd+S	In Writer, requests device saving; verify its resulting status
Escape	Closes supported dialogs when no protected save is pending
1, 2, 3, 4	In the reinspection walk-through outside fields, selects Corrected, Progress, No change or No access
U	Undoes the last result within the current worksheet context

Held keys do not repeatedly result items. Typing a digit or U into an editable field remains ordinary text entry. Use the visible outcome controls for the same actions on touch devices.

Read the whole task. Review all items provides an alternative to one-item walk-through. Reports provides tables alongside supported maps. Expand Full wording and guidance for complete language rather than depending on a truncated preview. Program instructions provides an accessible HTML manual as well as the printable copy.

Small screens and zoom. The five Writer destinations remain available. Use vertical scrolling and the applicable table's own scroll area when a wide data table needs it. At high zoom, inspect the actual field labels and current action rather than relying on desktop positions. The HTML manual reflows at 320 CSS pixels and supports browser zoom and find.

Display preferences. Select High contrast when useful, or use System with the operating system preference. Reduced motion follows the browser setting. Printed issued documents have their own fixed layout; a screen theme does not change the historical body.

Automated accessibility scans, theme checks, focus tests and narrow-width checks are included in the release evidence. They do not certify full WCAG 2.2 AA conformance. The City still needs manual screen-reader, keyboard, touch, zoom and real task testing with staff and its chosen assistive technology. Record the browser, screen reader, task, expected result and actual result in the acceptance record. Report a blocked control with its visible label and current case state, using synthetic records where possible.

21 Troubleshoot common problems

Preserve work first. Keep the active tab open when device saving is uncertain, download a workspace backup when offered, and record the exact message and time. The following actions do not require editing operational case files.

Symptom	Next action
Shared program files failed verification	Keep the installed verified version; give IT the message and time. Do not remove the pin or copy selected program files
Open from the installed desktop shortcut	Use the trusted installed shortcut in the original browser profile; preserve site data and unfinished work
Helper session changed or request refused	Reload to reconnect, then inspect the retained save state before retrying the original action
GIS URL or SQL server refused	IT checks the named setting against the connection allowlist in trusted-connections.json; do not weaken the check
PDF contains an external resource or active element	Preserve the issued original and report the error; use embedded approved document resources rather than external or local file references
The case could not be exported	Keep the case open and preserve the workspace backup if available; no empty case file should be written
Report could not be sorted	Default order is shown with a notice; review order before export and report the error if it repeats
No eligible inspection results	Open Source and import details and read the result status. Completed, Official Notice, Citation and Compliance are supported; Scheduled, Pending, Assist, unknown statuses and missing actual dates cannot be imported. If valid results are absent, use the complete R51 installation and retrieve the case again. An already used result requires Continue existing case
An older helper is running	Close its helper window and Writer tabs, then run the approved launcher again; confirm both R51 versions
A case is missing from Workspace	Clear workspace search/inspector filters, inspect All cases, then use Search all cases for the share
Lookup finds only Scheduled or Assist records	Confirm the source inspection was actually completed; use the division's report procedure, not a fabricated date
SQL or certificate error	Give IT the safe error code and time; check approved network, account, database and certificate configuration
Import says the inspection is already used	Continue its retained case/document or use correction; do not change the time to bypass matching
No Approved language results	Clear search; check review status. Use Approved and standard only deliberately under division policy
An unfilled bubble blocks issue	Open the linked item, enter the actual missing detail and review the completed sentence
Too many deadlines	Review outstanding items and reduce to the permitted distinct dates; do not relabel compliance or withdrawal
Deposit needs review or history changed	Complete the affected charge and authorized source; refresh shared history and review the tier again

Symptom	Next action
Mandatory wording hold	Preserve the draft; the division must supply approved defendant instructions for integration
Save confirmation needed	Confirm the original attempt; do not create another action
This record was changed outside the program	Stop editing; preserve evidence and refer to the administrator for trusted-source review
Migration registry damaged	Preserve the case folder and integrity evidence; IT reviews offline recovery
PDF filing needed or filename conflict	Open the issued action or PDF outbox; retain exact bytes and ask IT to resolve conflicting targets
Report totals differ from expectation	Check dates, active chips, definitions, read time and excluded summaries before requesting a rebuild
Outlook did not send	Inspect the draft and attachments and complete the actual send step; filing is not delivery

For helper support, the current local structured log is %LOCALAPPDATA%\MadisonDocWriter\logs\helper.jsonl. A failed SQL lookup may also create case-lookup-diagnostic.txt in that program folder. Review logs before providing them to authorized IT; they may contain local paths, server or account details. The next SQL failure can replace its diagnostic file.

If a control still fails after the safe next action, preserve the backup and error evidence. Ask the administrator to reproduce it with a copied or synthetic case. Do not retry by deleting registry, lock, receipt or history files.

22 Practice tasks and reference terms

Use an isolated acceptance deployment and unmistakably synthetic records. Each exercise should finish with both the expected document state and the correct explanation of what still needs action. The detailed acceptance record supplies participant fields and signoff criteria.

Import and notice. Find a synthetic ordinary case, verify one completed inspection, add two selectable items, fill the bubbles and assign a deadline. Save and reopen. Review and issue after approval, then explain device save, shared confirmation, PDF filing and actual delivery separately.

Snow. Import a known test Snow Removal case. Enter actual synthetic accumulation/inspection facts, photographs and condition. Review property history, season content, price and four copies. Check that no ordinary deadline or invented reinspection appears. Complete seasonal/policy review before any operational use.

Reinspection. Open a retained notice, use each outcome on a test item, undo one, pause to review all and resume unfinished details. Enter distinct physical/result/deadline dates correctly. Choose an eligible document; return to the worksheet and restore its paired previous draft. Confirm only one visit when adding a compatible scoped action.

Correction and recovery. Correct a synthetic issued typo, review before/after and verify the original remains. Interrupt a test save response and confirm the retained attempt. Recover one unfinished case, restore a workspace into an empty profile, and verify the exact issued PDF bytes. Test deployment rollback separately.

Reports and accessibility. Find a report, apply and reset filters, sort it, export CSV/workbook and compare the matching rows. Open a case and return. Explain exclusions and unlocated map points. Repeat core navigation using keyboard, touch and the approved screen reader; record problems, help requests and actual timings.

Term	Meaning in this program
Draft	Unissued private working state; validation may still be incomplete
Issued	Action confirmed in the shared case record
Frozen source	Retained wording, policy and facts for that issued version
Revision	Exact case-file content used to validate a reporting summary
Original PDF	Retained prepared bytes and receipt for an issued action
Visit	One genuinely completed physical inspection, possibly supporting compatible actions
Correction	Linked amendment preserving the original and stable identities
Anchor	Independently protected receipt supporting history integrity verification
Workspace	The current browser profile's loaded cases and unfinished work

The release package records technical verification and remaining City acceptance. Use the carried-forward R51-ACCEPTANCE-RECORD.md to record the remaining City tests and approvals. Historical release reviews explain development provenance and do not override this R51 manual.